

Bowel Awareness

Practice One · Top-Priority Function · Full Script · 4 minutes (audio) / full script below

The audio version of this practice uses a shorter, condensed reading of this script. This is the complete text, with all four phases, for reading alongside the audio or using on its own.

Opening · Breath and Light · 3 minutes

Find a position that feels comfortable. This practice works with bowel awareness — if you have a regular routine, you may find it fits well in the calmer time after that. Trust what feels right today.

Take a slow breath in through your nose, and let it out through your mouth. Again. Slower. Let your breathing find its own rhythm.

Bring attention to the top of your head. The crown. Just above it, a soft point of light — felt, not pictured. Each in-breath, brighter. Each out-breath, deeper.

Now let the light begin to travel. Through the crown, the throat, the chest, past the navel, into the pelvic bowl. A soft golden warmth pooling in the lower belly.

Phase One · The Ideal Being · 3 minutes

A figure begins to form in front of you. Whoever this figure is for you. This figure has a body whose bowel moves at its own rhythm — predictable, manageable, without anxiety. There are no accidents, no endless waiting. Just a calm working system the figure trusts.

The figure moves toward you. Steps into you. You aren't watching anymore — you are the figure. Their calm working system is yours. Their trust in their body is your trust in your body. You feel from inside the quiet awareness in your lower belly. The light still warm in the pelvic bowl, settling everything.

Phase Two · The Pathway · 3 minutes

Now we move closer in. Begin at the brain — the part that has always known how the bowel is. Follow the line down through the spinal cord, past the chest and lower back, to the sacral level — where the bowel lives.

This is where the conversation happens. Signals up from the bowel, signals down from the brain. Feel the nerves leaving the spinal cord, branching outward, reaching the colon and the pelvic floor.

Gently — bring awareness to the lower belly. Listen. Then gently try to soften the pelvic floor. The intention to release. Then reverse — the gentle intention to hold, the pelvic floor lifting just slightly. Whatever happens or doesn't happen, the signal is real. Feel the whole circuit, in both directions.

Closing · Breath and Light · 3 minutes

Return to the breath. The light is still in the pelvic bowl. The work is settling in. The signals you sent are real.

Your body moves through natural rhythms all day. About every 90 minutes, your mind drifts. When you feel that drift, return for a breath or two to the warmth in the pelvic bowl.

At night, as you drift toward sleep, the practice is especially potent. A few breaths of pelvic awareness as you fall asleep carries the work into your dreams. Same when you first wake.

Take one more slow breath in. Let it out. Notice the room. The light is yours. The pathway is yours. The practice continues. Thank you.

This practice is part of the Guided Imagery Programme at livingbeyondsci.com, free to use. It is not a substitute for medical advice, and does not claim to reverse or cure spinal cord injury. If any part of it increases discomfort, stop and try a different practice.